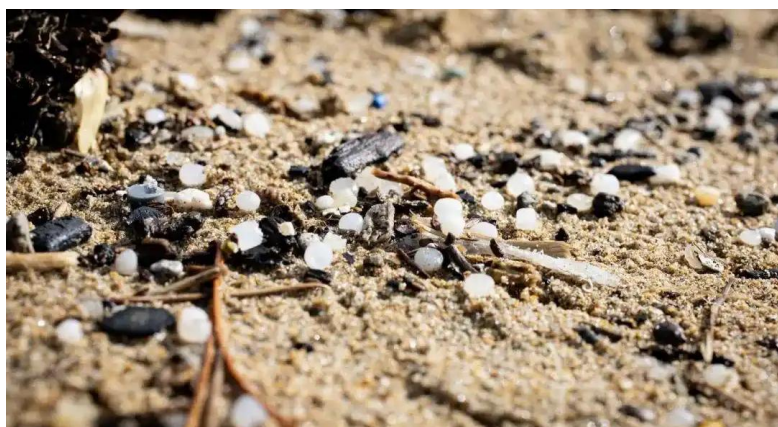




Volunteers race to clear coastline of plastic pellets

英国一海岸塑料颗粒泄露，民间志愿者竞相清理

难度评级：★★★★☆☆

【 Para.1 】

“You’ve got a local community that really cares about the coastline,” says Alice Lavery, reflecting on the huge **army** of volunteers that has taken to **crisis-hit** beaches in north-east England with passion and only the most basic tools. “They’ve all got a **dustpan**, a brush, a bucket, a kitchen **sieve**.”

“我们当地社区很关注海岸线，”爱丽丝·拉弗蒂说道。她回顾了那支庞大的志愿者队伍——他们满怀热情，仅凭最基本的工具，便奔赴了英格兰东北部遭受危机的海滩。“他们每个人都只带着一个簸箕、一把刷子、一个水桶和一个厨房用筛子。”

【 Para.2 】

On beaches from Cambois in Northumberland to Seaburn

文章导读：

英国东北部民间自发组织，清洁海滩塑料。7月附近海面发生冲撞事故，致使10亿颗塑料颗粒入海，引发大规模抗议。不少民众自发清理海滩塑料。这股民间力量现颇有组织。地方议会则仍偏保守，建议民众不要接触。但不少参与者关心当地生态，坚持持续清理。塑料颗粒对海洋破坏力不小，且也是个全球性问题。不少官方和地方机构也参与到此次清理工作。

pellet n. /'pelɪt/ a small hard ball of any substance, often of soft material that has become hard 小球；团粒；丸

food pellets for chickens 团粒鸡食

army n. a large number of people or things, especially when they are organized in some way or involved in a particular activity 大批；大群【考研大纲词汇】

an army of advisers/volunteers

一大批顾问；志愿者大军

crisis-hit a. 遭遇危机的

hit v. 【考研大纲词汇】 to have a bad effect on sb/sth 产生不良影响；打击；危害

Spain was one of the hardest hit countries.

西班牙是遭受打击最严重的国家之一。

dustpan n. a small flat container with a handle into which dust is brushed from the floor 簸箕

sieve n. /sɪv/ a tool for separating solids from liquids or larger solids from smaller solids, made of a wire or plastic net attached to a ring. The liquid or small pieces pass through the net but the larger pieces do not. 滤器；筛子；笊篱；漏勺

painstakingly adv. 十分小心地；极其仔细地

Broken bones were painstakingly pieced together and reshaped. 断裂的骨头被十分小心地拼凑到一起重新成形。

painstaking a. /'peɪnzteɪkɪŋ/ [usually before noun] needing a lot of care, effort and attention to detail 需细心的；辛苦的；需专注的

SYN thorough

painstaking research 细心的研究

sift v. /sɪft/ If you sift a powder such as flour or sand, you put it through a sieve in order to remove large pieces or lumps. 筛（面粉、沙子等）

Sift the flour and baking powder into a medium-sized mixing bowl.

把面粉和发酵粉筛到一个中号搅拌碗中。

on Wearside up to 2,000 dedicated volunteers have been **painstakingly sifting** through sand to find tiny plastic pellets.

从诺森伯兰郡的坎博伊斯到韦尔赛德的西伯恩，多达2000名热心的志愿者一直在海滩上费力地筛沙，寻找微小的塑料颗粒。

【 Para.3 】

The **lentil**-sized pellets called **nurdles** have washed up on beaches after a ship **collision** on 19 July at the Port of Tyne, South Shields, led to 1bn of them spilling into the water. Campaigners estimate there were up to 25 tonnes of them.

这些被称为nurdles的塑料颗粒为扁豆大小，是在7月19日南希尔兹泰恩港发生船只相撞事故后冲上岸的——该事故导致10亿颗塑料颗粒泄漏入海。环保活动人士估计，泄漏量高达25吨。

【 Para.4 】

The spill **prompted** anger and protests, and the north-east mayor, Kim McGuinness, has promised to make sure that shipowners contribute to what she said was a “pollution emergency”.

此次泄漏事件引发了公众的愤怒和抗议，东北部市长金·麦金尼斯承诺将确保船东为她所称的这件“污染紧急事件”承担责任。

【 Para.5 】

Since the collision the nurdles have washed up on numerous beaches in the region. Some days, nurdle drifts have been like soup, visibly **scarring** the landscape. Other days, people have had to get down on their hands and knees to

lentil n. /'lentl/ Lentils are the seeds of a lentil plant. They are usually dried and are used to make soups and stews. 兵豆

nurdle n. /'nɜː.dəl/ one of many very small round pieces of plastic used as a raw material (= a material before it has been processed for use) in making plastic products: 塑料颗粒, 主要用于制造塑料制品的基础原料

collision n. A collision occurs when a moving object crashes into something. 碰撞【考研大纲词汇】

They were on their way to the airport when their van was involved in a **collision** with a car.

他们正往机场赶路的时候，其货车和一辆小汽车相撞了。

prompt v. /prɒmpt/ to make sb decide to do sth; to cause sth to happen 促使；导致；激起【考研大纲词汇】

SYN provoke

The discovery of the bomb **prompted** an increase in security.

此次发现炸弹促使当局加强了安全工作。

scar v. (of a wound, etc. 伤口等) to leave a mark on the skin after it has healed 在...上结疤；给...留下疤痕【考研大纲词汇】

His face was badly **scarred**.

他的脸上留下了明显的疤痕。

horrendous a. /hɒ'rendəs/ extremely shocking 令人震惊的；骇人的

SYN horrific, horrifying

horrendous injuries 可怕的伤势

fuel v. to increase sth; to make sth stronger 增加；加强；刺激【考研大纲词汇】

SYN stoke

to **fuel** speculation/rumours/fears

引起猜测/谣传/恐惧

outrage n. /'aʊtreɪdʒ/ [U] a strong feeling of shock and anger 愤怒；义愤；愤慨【考研大纲词汇】

The judge's remarks caused public **outrage**.

裁判的话引起了公愤。

addictive a. if an activity or type of behaviour is addictive, people need to do it as often as possible because they enjoy it 使人入迷的

I find jogging very **addictive**.

我觉得慢跑锻炼很使人着迷。

reckon v. /'rekən/ (informal) (especially BrE) to think sth or have an opinion about sth 想；认为【考研大纲词汇】

I **reckon** (that) I'm going to get that job.

我认为我会得到那份工作。

sympathetic a. /sɪmpə'tetɪk/ ~ (to/towards sb) kind to sb who is hurt or sad; showing that you understand and care about their problems 同情的；有同情心的；表示同情的【考研大纲词汇】

a **sympathetic** listener 体谅别人的听者

find them – but when they do, they're there.

自碰撞事故发生以来，这些塑料颗粒已冲上该地区众多海滩。有些日子，漂浮的塑料颗粒密密麻麻，宛如一锅浓汤，明显破坏了海岸景观。有些日子，人们不得不跪在地上寻找——但一旦开始找，就能发现它们。

【 Para.6 】

Laverty, a Whitley Bay bookshop owner, was one of the first to respond. “I saw the **horrendous** pictures of millions of them floating down the Tyne and I went to the beach in the evening,” she says.

惠特利湾一家书店的店主拉弗蒂是首批采取行动的人之一。“我看到了数百万颗塑料颗粒顺泰恩河漂流而下的骇人画面，当晚我就去了海滩，”她说。

【 Para.7 】

“I was literally the only person on the beach with a dustpan and brush and I could see people looking at me going ... ‘what is she doing?’ ”

“当时海滩上真的只有我一个人拿着簸箕和扫帚，我能感觉到人们看着我，心里在想……‘她到底在干什么？’ ”

【 Para.8 】

Fuelled by **outrage** and helped by WhatsApp and social media, there is now a more organised army of volunteers gathering at beaches in the mornings and evenings to help the cleanup. It is a race against the tides, and the only way for volunteers to do it is by painstakingly sifting the sand or

liability n. [U]~ (for sth)~ (to do sth) the state of being legally responsible for sth (法律上对某事物的) 责任, 义务
The company cannot accept **liability** for any damage caused by natural disasters.
该公司对自然灾害造成的任何损失概不承担责任。

breed v. [usually passive]~ sth into sb to educate sb in a particular way as they are growing up以...方式教育; 使养成
【考研大纲词汇】
Fear of failure was **bred** into him at an early age.
他从小就养成了对失败的恐惧。

born and bred phrase born and having grown up in a particular place with a particular background and education (在某地) 出生长大; 受过...熏陶
He was **born and bred** in Boston.
他生于波士顿, 长于波士顿。

coexist v. /ˈkɔːɪɡˈzɪst/ ~ (with sb/sth) (formal) to exist together in the same place or at the same time, especially in a peaceful way共存; (尤指) 和平共处
The illness frequently **coexists** with other chronic diseases.
这种病往往与其他慢性病同时存在。

mobilise v. /ˈməʊbaɪˈlaɪz/ If you mobilize support or mobilize people to do something, you succeed in encouraging people to take action, especially political action. If people mobilize, they prepare to take action. 动员; 动员起来【考研大纲词汇】
The best hope is that we will **mobilize** international support and get down to action.
最大的希望就是我们将动员国际社会的支持, 开始行动。

deadly a. If something is deadly, it is likely or able to cause someone's death, or has already caused someone's death. 致命的; 致死的【考研大纲词汇】
He was acquitted on charges of assault with a **deadly** weapon. 他用凶器伤人的罪名不成立。

➤ 今日句子分析

Fuelled by outrage and

原因状语 1 (并列连词)

helped by WhatsApp and social media, there is

原因状语 2 形式主语 谓语

now a more organised army of volunteers

主语 (真正)

gathering at beaches in the mornings and evenings

后置定语

to help the cleanup.

目的状语

shaking seaweed. People have been drawing squares and cleaning the beach section by section.

在愤怒情绪的驱使下，加上WhatsApp和社交媒体的传播，如今当地形成了一支更有组织的志愿者队伍，每天早晚聚集在海滩上协助清理工作。这是一场与潮汐赛跑的较量，志愿者们唯一能做到的就是费力地筛沙或抖落海藻。人们划出方格，逐段清理海滩。

【 Para.9 】

“It becomes quite **addictive**,” Lavery says. “I can’t walk past a nurdle without picking it up, and I **reckon** most Whitley Bay residents will be exactly the same.”

“这简直让人上瘾，”拉弗蒂说，“我路过一个塑料颗粒都忍不住要捡起来，我想惠特利湾的大多数居民应该也一样。”

【 Para.10 】

She says a friend had told her the Greek myth of Aphrodite punishing Psyche by mixing up different grains, seeds and lentils and setting her the impossible task of separating them by dawn. In the story, a **sympathetic** army of ants comes to the rescue. “Wouldn’t that be great,” says Lavery.

她提到一位朋友曾向她讲述过希腊神话中阿芙罗狄蒂惩罚普西刻的故事：阿芙罗狄蒂将各种谷物、种子和扁豆混在一起，并给普西刻布置了一项在黎明前必须完成但又不可能完成的任务——将它们分拣出来。故事中，一支富有同情心的蚂蚁大军前来相助。“（要真能这样）那该多好啊，”拉弗蒂说道。

【 Para.11 】

句子分析：

主句：

原因状语-Fuelled by outrage and helped by WhatsApp and social media（两个短语并列，且都是解释为什么会出现这样一支队伍）；

（there be句型）形式主语-there；谓语-is；真正主语-now a more organised army of volunteers（重点在于这个more organized 暗示之前其实也有志愿者队伍，但现在更加有组织，now则进一步加强了这个变化，需要翻译出来）；后置定语-gathering at beaches in the mornings and evenings（强调“早晚都在”）to help the cleanup.

写作积累

Para.10 In the story, a sympathetic army of ants comes to the rescue. 这里的come to the rescue可以拆为两部分come (前来)+to the rescue (为了救助……)，例：A wealthy benefactor came to their rescue with a generous donation.一位富有的赞助人慷慨解囊挽救了他们。

come to one’s aid/ the support 同理，意为“前来/站出来支持/帮助……”。

而come to (介词)+sth还有多种搭配，例如：

come to a halt/stop “停下来”，例：Please remain seated until the aircraft has come to a halt. 飞机停好以前，请坐着别动。

come to a conclusion/an end “得出结论/结束”，例：I was heartsick, for I felt that the splendid years of my carefree childhood had come to an end. 我很难过，因为我觉得我无忧无虑的美好童年生活结束了。

come to realize “逐渐意识到……”，例：People didn’t come to realize the importance of planting trees until they (had) experienced a number of serious natural disasters.

经历了多次严重自然灾害后，人们才逐渐意识到植树造林的重要性。

Para.12 At Whitley Bay beach the Guardian talked to other volunteers determined to do their bit.

do one’s bit指“尽自己的一份力”，这里的bit是“一点点/一小部分”的意思，因此这个短语带有一定的谦逊意味，类似于“尽绵薄之力”，例：We can finish this job on time if everyone does their bit.要是每个人都尽职，我们就能按时完成这项工作。

相近表达还有：

do one’s part “尽本职” We can finish this job on time if everyone does their bit.要是每个人都尽职，我们就能按时完成这项工作。

pull one’s weight “尽本分” He accused the team of not pulling their weight. 他指责队员们没有尽到自己的本分。

The official advice from councils is not to handle the pellets, but Lavery says there is a greater cause: “There’s no nurdle fairy; this needs to be cleaned up now,” she says. “An official response with specialist equipment and trained staff takes time, and concerns about insurance and **liability** could further delay cleanup operations.”

地方议会的官方建议是不要接触这些塑料颗粒，但拉弗蒂表示还有更重要的原因：“没有‘塑料颗粒仙女’；这些颗粒必须现在就清理干净，”她说，“官方调用专业设备和受过培训的人员需要时间，而有关保险和责任的顾虑可能会进一步延误清理工作。”

【 Para.12 】

At Whitley Bay beach the Guardian talked to other volunteers determined to do their bit.

在惠特利湾海滩，《卫报》采访了其他决心尽自己一份力的志愿者。

【 Para.13 】

Helen Charlton, a business academic from Cramlington in Northumberland, says: “This is our home. I’m north-east born and **bred** and I’m incredibly proud of this region, and I’m incredibly proud of the industry and commerce here.

来自诺森伯兰郡克拉姆灵顿的商学学者海伦·查尔顿说：“这里是我们的家。我是土生土长的东北部人，对这一地区感到无比自豪，也对这里的工业和商业感到无比自豪。”

【 Para.14 】

“It’s not that we shouldn’t have shipping on the Tyne because we absolutely should. But the two have to **coexist**.”

“并不是说泰恩河上不应该有航运，因为航运绝对是必要的。但两者必须共存。”

【 Para.15 】

Lou Shackleton, a life and work coach from Whitley Bay, says the nurdles bring multiple dangers. “Everything is interconnected. The people that are fishing need the fish to be there and healthy. The seals need the fish. I heard a boat broke down yesterday because of nurdles affecting the engine. It’s the summer holidays; there’ll be people in the sea, kids playing.”

来自惠特利湾的生活与职业教练卢·沙克尔顿表示，这些塑料颗粒带来了多重危险。“万物都是相互关联的。捕鱼的人需要鱼群存在且健康；海豹也需要鱼。我听说昨天有一艘船因为塑料颗粒影响发动机而抛锚了。现在正值暑假，海里会有游人，孩子们也会在海里玩耍。

【 Para.16 】

“I have a five-year-old. I don’t want him to be still finding nurdles on the beach in 10 years’ time.”

“我有个五岁的孩子。我不希望10年后他还在海滩上捡塑料颗粒。”

【 Para.17 】

Amy Ash, a user experience designer, has created an app to help organise and **mobilise** the volunteers.

用户体验设计师艾米·阿什（Amy Ash）开发了一款应用程序，用于协助组织和动员志愿者。

【 Para.18 】

“I surf, I swim, I’ve got two kids,” she says. “It is absolutely devastating that these things are on the beach. I really do not want this to be forgotten about.”

“我平时冲浪，也游泳，我还有两个孩子，”她说，“海滩上出现这些东西简直太令人痛心了。我真的不希望这件事被人们遗忘。”

【 Para.19 】

Nurdles are tiny, disc-shaped plastic pellets that are the raw material to manufacture most plastic products. Animals can easily mistake them for food with **deadly** consequences, campaigners say.

塑料颗粒指微小的圆盘状塑料丸，是制造大多数塑料产品的原材料。活动人士表示，动物很容易将它们误认为食物，从而引发致命后果。

【 Para.20 】

The environmental charity Fidra, which works to end

plastic and chemical pollution, says they are a global problem. Last year it found plastic nurdles at 84% of sites of special scientific interest.

致力于消除塑料和化学污染的环境慈善组织Fidra表示，这是一个全球性问题。去年，该组织在84%的特殊科学兴趣地点发现了塑料颗粒。

【 Para.21 】

The Port of Tyne, HM Coastguard, the Environment Agency, local councils and contractors are all involved in cleaning up the spill. But yesterday about 3,000 volunteer hours had been logged and 285kg of nurdles had been recovered by the “people’s army”. A call was to go out for trained local teams to be allowed to help clear nurdles from rivers as well as beaches.

泰恩港、英国海岸警卫队、环境署、地方议会及承包商均参与了此次泄漏事故的清理工作。但截至昨日，“民众大军”已累计贡献约3,000小时的志愿服务时间，并回收了285公斤塑料颗粒。相关方面将呼吁允许受过培训的当地团队协助清理河流及海滩上的塑料颗粒。